

CHILD CARE COSTS

National Database of Childcare Prices
U.S. Department of Labor - Women's Bureau, 2024

49

States Analyzed

4×

Cost Variation

\$171

Avg. Infant Care/Week

28%

Max Income Burden

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

"Childcare costs represent a crisis of affordability across America"

- 💰

Infant care dominates costs

Average **\$171/week** for center-based care
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Geographic inequality

Northeast costs **58% more** than South
- 💵

Income burden crisis

From **11% to 28%** of family income
- 🏠

Family care savings

33% savings over center-based care

COST BY AGE GROUP

Weekly costs for center-based care



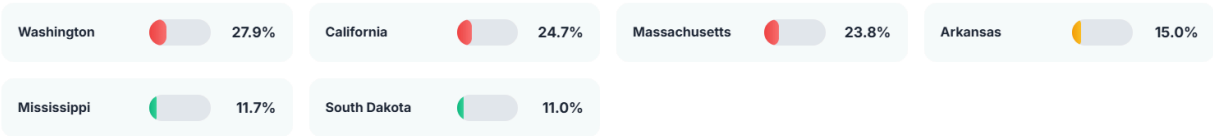
REGIONAL BREAKDOWN

Average infant care costs by region



AFFORDABILITY CRISIS

Infant care as percentage of median household income



CENTER VS FAMILY CARE

Age Group	Center-Based Care	Family Child Care	Weekly Savings
Infant	\$171/week	\$113/week	\$58 (34%)
Toddler	\$154/week	\$107/week	\$47 (31%)
Preschool	\$141/week	\$105/week	\$36 (26%)
School Age	\$113/week	\$87/week	\$26 (23%)

POLICY IMPLICATIONS



High-Cost Regions

Northeast and West Coast states face severe affordability challenges, with families spending up to 28% of income on childcare.



Rural-Urban Divide

Southern and Midwest states offer affordability but may struggle with quality and availability issues.



Family Care Alternative

Family childcare provides substantial savings but requires supportive regulation and quality assurance.



Age-Based Intervention

Infant care represents the highest burden, demanding targeted policy solutions and subsidies.

Data Coverage

49 states and territories analyzed

Missing Data

Indiana, New Mexico

Methodology

Market rate surveys, median income analysis

Source: National Database of Childcare Prices, U.S. Department of Labor - Women's Bureau, 2024